

SOFTWARE

What software will drive the future? Will things change radically, or is it going to be a case of same old, same old...

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Nothing tech changes more frequently than software. The changes aren't usually radical, but are consistent. Most of the time it's just a few additions of features, some bug fixes, a new user interface—nothing extraordinary. Sometimes, however, changes are radical—you go from a Windows XP to a Vista. Apart from the

obvious and much-touted GUI changes, there's a lot more security and thought put into Vista. The same can be said for Microsoft's Office Suite: when Office 2007 was previewed in its beta stage, a lot of people hated it—many readers, a lot of us at *Digit*, and a considerable number online. Of course, it was just a knee-jerk reaction to the change, and barely a week later, we all loved it and couldn't live without the Ribbon.

Operating Systems

Microsoft's Vista, Apple's Leopard, what next?

For the end user, Vista is just a pretty XP, and in classic skin mode, Vista looks even more like its predecessor. This is because the way you use the computer hasn't changed much, there are no radical changes. The same applies to Apple's Leopard: there have been a lot more functions added to it, a lot more prettiness, but nothing radically different. Enter WinFS!

Windows Future Storage (WinFS) was a filesystem originally slated to be shipped with Vista (then Longhorn). Development schedules for other products pushed WinFS into the background. Currently, the status of WinFS is unknown, and despite Microsoft already announcing that they're starting development on the next Windows version, codenamed Vienna, there's no word on whether WinFS will

One Size Fits All—
universal Operating
System might just put an
end to the platform war